# THE PÓLYA–VINOGRADOV INEQUALITY WITH $\log\log q$

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Abstract. We prove unconditionally that every primitive Dirichlet character $\chi$ modulo $q \geq 3$ has character sums of size at most $C\sqrt{q}\log\log q$. Montgomery and Vaughan proved this bound under the generalised Riemann hypothesis, and Paley showed that it is optimal. The proof uses the zero-free half-plane $\operatorname{Re} s > 7/8$, which also gives $|L'/L(1,\chi)| \ll \log\log q$ and two-sided bounds for the Euler–Kronecker constants of the cyclotomic fields $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$.

## 1. Introduction

Let $\chi$ be a primitive Dirichlet character modulo $q \geq 3$. The Pólya–Vinogradov inequality states that $\left|\sum_{n\leq x}\chi(n)\right| \ll \sqrt{q}\log q$ uniformly in $x$ [6, Chapter 23].[1] Paley proved that the factor $\log q$ cannot be replaced by anything smaller than $\log\log q$: for infinitely many primitive quadratic characters the maximum over $x$ exceeds $c\sqrt{q}\log\log q$ [15]. Montgomery and Vaughan [12] proved the upper bound $\sqrt{q}\log\log q$ under the generalised Riemann hypothesis. Without hypothesis, Granville and Soundararajan lowered the exponent of $\log q$ for characters of fixed odd order [8].[2] We prove the bound of Montgomery and Vaughan for every primitive character.

**Theorem 1.1.** *There is an absolute constant $C$ such that for every primitive character $\chi$ modulo $q \geq 3$ and every $x \geq 1$,*

$$\left|\sum_{n\leq x}\chi(n)\right| \leq C\sqrt{q}\log\log q.$$

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* Primary 11L40; Secondary 11M06, 11M20, 11L07, 11N13, 11N36, 11R42.

*Key words and phrases.* Pólya–Vinogradov inequality, character sums, zero-free regions, Selberg sieve, Euler–Kronecker constants.

Corresponding author: Deep Bhattacharjee. An earlier version of this paper is the Hexagon preprint `2610.00256v1`, `https://hexagonmath.org/2610.00256v1`.

[1] The proof expands $\chi$ in additive characters through the Gauss sum $\tau(\bar{\chi})$, whose modulus is $\sqrt{q}$ for primitive $\chi$, and bounds the resulting geometric series trivially; Lemma 5.1 below is the same argument with the harmonic sums kept.

[2] For a primitive character of odd order $g$ they obtain $\sqrt{q}(\log q)^{1-\delta_g/2+o(1)}$ with $\delta_g = 1-\frac{g}{\pi}\sin\frac{\pi}{g}$, and under the generalised Riemann hypothesis the same exponent of $\log\log q$.

By Paley's theorem, Theorem 1.1 is optimal up to the value of $C$. The input that replaces the Riemann hypothesis is the following theorem.

**Theorem 1.2** ([14]). *If $\chi$ is a nonprincipal Dirichlet character, then $L(s,\chi) \neq 0$ for $\operatorname{Re} s > 7/8$.*

Theorem 1.2 is proved, and formalised in Lean 4, in [14]. It is the only result we use without proof; everything else is proved below from first principles, and the constants are effective.

Montgomery and Vaughan use the Riemann hypothesis in one place: on the major arcs, for prime sums of the characters $\chi\psi$ twisted by additive characters, where $\psi$ runs over the characters of a small modulus $r$. A power saving in these sums is enough there, and Theorem 1.2 provides one (Corollary 3.8). On the minor arcs they use their unconditional bound for exponential sums with multiplicative coefficients. A weaker form of it suffices, and we prove that form in Section 4 with Selberg's sieve as the only arithmetic input. Figure 1 shows how the parts fit together.

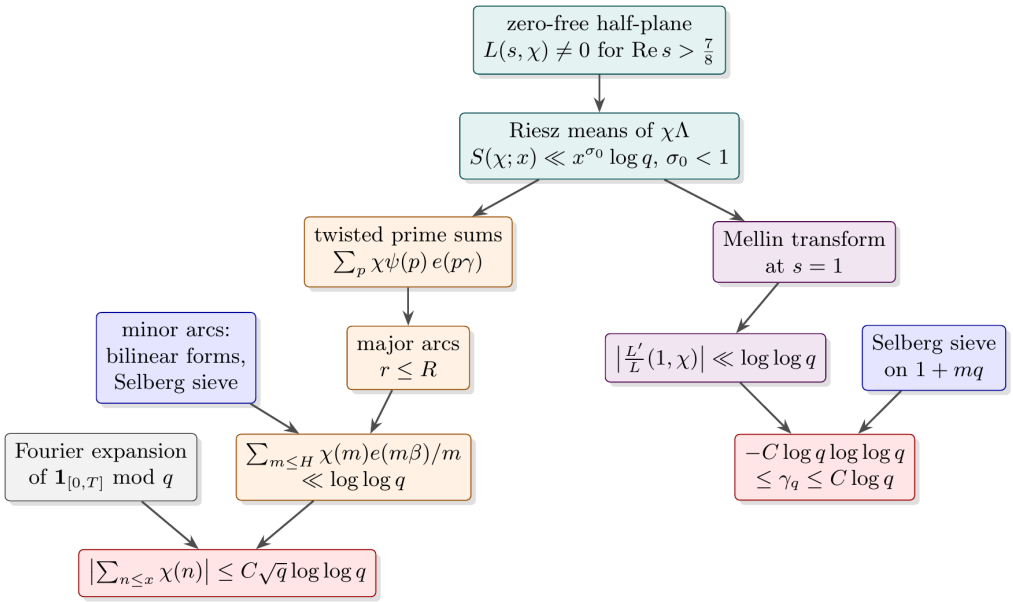



FIGURE 1. The structure of the proofs. The left branch proves Theorem 1.1: the Fourier expansion of a character sum reduces it to the sums $\sum_{m \le H} \chi(m)e(m\beta)/m$, which are bounded on the major arcs by the half-plane and on the minor arcs by bilinear forms and the sieve. The right branch proves Theorem 1.3.

The same half-plane controls the logarithmic derivative of $L(s,\chi)$ at $s = 1$. For a number field $K$ write $\zeta_K(s) = c_{-1}(s-1)^{-1} + c_0 + O(s-1)$

near $s = 1$; the Euler–Kronecker constant of $K$ is $\gamma_K = c_0/c_{-1}$. Let $\gamma_q$ be the Euler–Kronecker constant of $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$. For a prime $q$ the factorisation $\zeta_{\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)}(s) = \zeta(s)\prod_{\chi\neq\chi_0} L(s,\chi)$, the product over the nonprincipal characters modulo $q$ [16, Theorem 4.3],[3] gives

$$\gamma_q = \gamma + \sum_{\chi\neq\chi_0} \frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi), \tag{1.1}$$

where $\gamma$ is Euler's constant.

**Theorem 1.3.** *There is an absolute constant $C$ with the following properties.*

(i) *For every nonprincipal character $\chi$ modulo $q$,*

$$\left|\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi)\right| \le C\log\log q.$$

(ii) *For every prime $q \ge 3$, $-C\log q\log\log q \le \gamma_q \le C\log q$.*

Under the generalised Riemann hypothesis the bound (i) is classical, Ihara proved $\gamma_q \le (2+o(1))\log q$ and Badzyan proved a lower bound of the order of (ii) [10, 1]. Ford, Luca and Moree proved the two bounds of (ii) without hypothesis for a set of primes $q$ of density one [7, 13].[4] For all primes the best unconditional bound we know is $|\gamma_q| \ll_\varepsilon q^\varepsilon$, due to Ihara, Murty and Shimura [11]. The upper bound in (ii) needs only Chebyshev's bound. The lower bound needs an upper bound for the prime powers $n \le q^{17}$ with $n \equiv 1 \pmod q$, which we obtain from Selberg's sieve applied in dyadic blocks (Lemma 6.3).

We have not found Theorem 1.1 or Theorem 1.3 among the consequences of Theorem 1.2 drawn in [14] or in the work that followed it. The arguments work, with other constants, whenever $L(s,\chi) \neq 0$ on $\operatorname{Re} s > \theta$ for all nonprincipal $\chi$ and some fixed $\theta < 1$. Related work of the first author concerns the Nyman–Beurling–Báez-Duarte approximation, an analytic criterion for zero-free half-planes of $\zeta(s)$ [5], large-sieve bounds for correlations of the Liouville function [2], and the Ramanujan $\tau$-function and its modular symmetry [4].

[3] All nonprincipal characters modulo a prime are primitive, so no Euler factors have to be removed: the conductor of each nonprincipal $\chi$ is $q$ itself, and $L(s,\chi)$ is the $L$-function of the corresponding primitive character.

[4] The difficulty for an individual prime $q$ lies in the prime powers $n \equiv 1 \pmod q$, which enter $\gamma_q$ with the weight $(q-1)\Lambda(n)/n$. Below $q^{17}$ we bound them for each prime $q$ separately by Lemma 6.3; beyond $q^{17}$ the zero-free half-plane makes their contribution bounded.

The paper is organised as follows. Section 2 collects Chebyshev's bounds and Selberg's sieve. Section 3 bounds Riesz means of $\chi\Lambda$ by a contour shift. Section 4 proves the bound for exponential sums with multiplicative coefficients, Section 5 proves Theorem 1.1 and Section 6 proves Theorem 1.3.

## 2. Preliminaries

Throughout, $p$ and $\ell$ denote primes, $\Lambda$ is the von Mangoldt function, $\theta(x)=\sum_{p\le x}\log p$, $\psi(x)=\sum_{n\le x}\Lambda(n)$, $e(x)=e^{2\pi ix}$, and $\|x\|$ is the distance from $x$ to the nearest integer. We write $\omega(n)$ for the number of prime factors of $n$, $\tau_3(n)$ for the number of ordered factorisations $n=abc$, and $P(n)$ for the largest prime factor of $n\ge 2$, with $P(1)=1$.

**Lemma 2.1.** *For $x\ge 1$ and integers $N\ge 2$,*

(i) $\theta(x)\le x\log 4$;
(ii) $\psi(x)-\theta(x)\le 2\sqrt{x}\log x$ *and* $\psi(x)\le 4x$;
(iii) $\sum_{p\le N}\frac{\log p}{p}\le \log N+\log 4$;
(iv) $\sum_{p\le N}\frac{1}{p}\le \log\log N+10$.

*Proof.* (i) It suffices to treat integers $m\ge 1$, and we use induction on $m$. The cases $m=1,2$ are clear, and for even $m>2$ we have $\theta(m)=\theta(m-1)$. Let $m=2n+1$. The primes in $(n+1,2n+1]$ divide $\binom{2n+1}{n}$, and $2\binom{2n+1}{n}\le 2^{2n+1}$ because $\binom{2n+1}{n}$ and $\binom{2n+1}{n+1}$ are equal terms of the binomial expansion of $(1+1)^{2n+1}$. Hence $\theta(2n+1)\le\theta(n+1)+n\log 4\le(2n+1)\log 4$.

(ii) We have $\psi(x)-\theta(x)=\sum_{k\ge 2}\theta(x^{1/k})$, where only $k\le\log x/\log 2$ contribute. Each term is at most $\sqrt{x}\log 4$ by (i), so the sum is at most $(\log x/\log 2)\sqrt{x}\log 4=2\sqrt{x}\log x$. Since $\log x\le\sqrt{x}$, $\psi(x)\le(\log 4+2)x\le 4x$.

(iii) By Legendre's formula and (i),

$$N\log N\ge\log N!\ge\sum_{p\le N}\Big\lfloor\frac{N}{p}\Big\rfloor\log p\ge N\sum_{p\le N}\frac{\log p}{p}-N\log 4.$$

(iv) Let $A(u)=\sum_{p\le u}\log p/p$. Partial summation and (iii) give

$$\sum_{p\le N}\frac{1}{p}=\frac{A(N)}{\log N}+\int_2^N\frac{A(u)}{u\log^2 u}\,du\le 1+\frac{\log 4}{\log 2}+\int_2^N\Big(\frac{1}{u\log u}+\frac{\log 4}{u\log^2 u}\Big)du,$$

and the integral is at most $\log\log N-\log\log 2+2$. □

We use Selberg's upper bound sieve in the following form; for the method see [9, Chapter 3], and we give the proof of the form we need.[5]

[5]The weights $\lambda_d$ are those of Selberg's quadratic form, and the only feature used later is the bound $|\lambda_d|\le 1$, which makes the remainder term at most a sum of $3^{\omega(d)}|R_d|$ over $d\le y$.

**Lemma 2.2.** *Let $a_1,\dots,a_X$ be integers, $P$ a squarefree integer, $\nu$ a multiplicative function with $0<\nu(p)<1$ for $p\mid P$, and $y\ge 1$. For $d\mid P$ put $R_d=\#\{n\le X : d\mid a_n\}-\nu(d)X$, and for $l\mid P$ put $g(l)=\prod_{p\mid l}\nu(p)/(1-\nu(p))$. Then*

$$\#\{n\le X:(a_n,P)=1\}\le \frac{X}{S}+\sum_{\substack{d\mid P\\ d\le y}} 3^{\omega(d)}|R_d|,\qquad S=\sum_{\substack{l\mid P\\ l\le\sqrt{y}}} g(l).$$

*Proof.* Let $D$ be the set of divisors $d$ of $P$ with $d\le\sqrt{y}$, and let $(\lambda_d)_{d\in D}$ be real numbers with $\lambda_1=1$. If $(a_n,P)=1$ then $\sum_{d\in D,\,d\mid a_n}\lambda_d=1$, and otherwise this sum is real, so

$$\begin{aligned}\#\{n:(a_n,P)=1\}&\le\sum_{n\le X}\Big(\sum_{\substack{d\in D\\ d\mid a_n}}\lambda_d\Big)^2\\ &=X\sum_{d_1,d_2\in D}\lambda_{d_1}\lambda_{d_2}\nu([d_1,d_2])+\sum_{d_1,d_2\in D}\lambda_{d_1}\lambda_{d_2}R_{[d_1,d_2]}.\end{aligned}$$

Write $Q$ for the double sum in the first term. Since $\nu$ is multiplicative and $d_1,d_2$ are squarefree, $\nu([d_1,d_2])=\nu(d_1)\nu(d_2)/\nu((d_1,d_2))$. Let $h$ be the multiplicative function on the divisors of $P$ with $h(p)=1/\nu(p)-1=1/g(p)$; then $1/\nu(m)=\sum_{l\mid m}h(l)$ for $m\mid P$, and

$$Q=\sum_{l\mid P}h(l)\Big(\sum_{\substack{d\in D\\ l\mid d}}\lambda_d\nu(d)\Big)^2=\sum_{l\in D}\frac{y_l^2}{g(l)},\qquad y_l=\sum_{\substack{d\in D\\ l\mid d}}\lambda_d\nu(d).$$

Möbius inversion gives $\lambda_d\nu(d)=\sum_{l\in D,\,d\mid l}\mu(l/d)y_l$, so the condition $\lambda_1=1$ reads $\sum_{l\in D}\mu(l)y_l=1$. By Cauchy's inequality

$$1\le\Big(\sum_{l\in D}\frac{y_l^2}{g(l)}\Big)\Big(\sum_{l\in D}g(l)\Big)=QS,$$

with equality for $y_l=\mu(l)g(l)/S$. We make this choice, so that $Q=1/S$. Then, writing $l=de$,

$$\lambda_d=\frac{1}{\nu(d)S}\sum_{\substack{l\in D\\ d\mid l}}\mu(l/d)\mu(l)g(l)=\frac{\mu(d)g(d)}{\nu(d)S}\sum_{\substack{e\in D,\ (e,d)=1\\ de\le\sqrt{y}}}g(e).$$

Since $g(d)/\nu(d)=\prod_{p\mid d}(1-\nu(p))^{-1}=\prod_{p\mid d}(1+g(p))=\sum_{f\mid d}g(f)$, we get $|\lambda_d|\le S^{-1}\sum_{f\mid d}\sum_e g(fe)$, and the products $fe$ are distinct elements of $D$; hence $|\lambda_d|\le 1$. Finally $[d_1,d_2]\le d_1d_2\le y$, and every $d\mid P$ is the least common multiple of at most $3^{\omega(d)}$ pairs $(d_1,d_2)$, so the second term is at most $\sum_{d\mid P,\,d\le y}3^{\omega(d)}|R_d|$. □

## 3. Riesz means of prime sums

For an arithmetic function $a$ and $x \geq 1$ put

$$S(a;x) = \sum_{n \leq x} a(n)\Big(1 - \frac{n}{x}\Big), \qquad S(\chi;x) = S(\chi\Lambda;x) = \sum_{n \leq x} \chi(n)\Lambda(n)\Big(1 - \frac{n}{x}\Big).$$

The weight $1 - n/x$ makes the Mellin kernel absolutely integrable, which keeps the contour shift below free of truncation errors. The aim of this section is Proposition 3.7.

**Lemma 3.1.** *Let $a\colon \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{C}$ satisfy $\sum_n |a(n)|n^{-\sigma} < \infty$ for $\sigma > 1$, and let $F(s) = \sum_n a(n)n^{-s}$ for $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$.*

(i) *For $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$, $\displaystyle\int_1^\infty S(a;x)\, x^{-s-1}\, dx = \frac{F(s)}{s(s+1)}$.*

(ii) *For $x > 0$, $\displaystyle S(a;x) = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} F(2+it)\, \frac{x^{2+it}}{(2+it)(3+it)}\, dt$.*

*In other words the following square commutes, and (ii) inverts its right column on the line $\operatorname{Re} s = 2$:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} a & \xrightarrow{\text{Riesz mean}} & S(a;\cdot) \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{Dirichlet series}} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{Mellin transform}} \\ F & \xrightarrow[\times \frac{1}{s(s+1)}]{} & \dfrac{F(s)}{s(s+1)} \end{array}$$

*Proof.* (i) For $n \geq 1$, $\int_n^\infty (1 - n/x)x^{-s-1}dx = n^{-s}/s - n^{-s}/(s+1) = n^{-s}/(s(s+1))$. Since $\sum_n |a(n)| \int_n^\infty x^{-\sigma-1}dx = \sigma^{-1}\sum_n |a(n)|n^{-\sigma} < \infty$, the sum and the integral may be exchanged.

(ii) For $y > 0$ let $k(y) = \frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_{(2)} y^s \frac{ds}{s(s+1)}$. If $y \geq 1$, moving the line of integration to $\operatorname{Re} s = -U$ and letting $U \to \infty$ picks up the residues 1 at $s = 0$ and $-1/y$ at $s = -1$, so $k(y) = 1 - 1/y$; if $y < 1$, moving it to the right gives $k(y) = 0$. As $|s(s+1)|^{-1}$ is integrable on $\operatorname{Re} s = 2$ and $\sum_n |a(n)|n^{-2} < \infty$, summation and integration may be exchanged, and the right side equals $\sum_n a(n)k(x/n) = S(a;x)$. □

**Lemma 3.2.** *Let $\chi$ be nonprincipal modulo $q$. For $\operatorname{Re} s = \sigma > 0$, $|L(s,\chi)| \leq q|s|/\sigma$.*

*Proof.* Put $A(t) = \sum_{n \leq t} \chi(n)$; then $|A(t)| \leq q$, and partial summation gives $L(s,\chi) = s\int_1^\infty A(t)t^{-s-1}\, dt$ for $\sigma > 0$. Hence $|L(s,\chi)| \leq q|s| \int_1^\infty t^{-\sigma-1}dt = q|s|/\sigma$. □

**Lemma 3.3.** *Let $A_0 = \frac{3}{2}\sum_\ell \ell^{-3/2}$. For every Dirichlet character $\chi$ the series $E(s) = -\sum_\ell \log(1-\chi(\ell)\ell^{-s})$ is holomorphic on $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$, $e^{E(s)} = L(s,\chi)$ there, and $|E(s)| \le A_0$ for $\operatorname{Re} s \ge 3/2$.*

*Proof.* For $\operatorname{Re} s \ge 1$ we have $|\chi(\ell)\ell^{-s}| \le 1/2$, and $|\log(1-w)| \le \sum_k |w|^k/k \le \frac{3}{2}|w|$ for $|w| \le 1/2$. The series therefore converges locally uniformly on $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$ and is bounded by $A_0$ on $\operatorname{Re} s \ge 3/2$, and the Euler product gives $e^E = L$. □

**Lemma 3.4** (Borel–Carathéodory)**.** *Let $h$ be holomorphic on a neighbourhood of the disc $|z-c| \le R$ and let $0 < r < R$. Then*

$$\max_{|z-c|\le r} |h(z)-h(c)| \le \frac{2r}{R-r} \max_{|w-c|=R} \operatorname{Re}\big(h(w)-h(c)\big).$$

*Proof.* Put $g(z) = h(c+z) - h(c)$ and $A = \max_{|w|=R} \operatorname{Re} g(w)$. The mean of $\operatorname{Re} g$ over the circle $|w| = R$ is $\operatorname{Re} g(0) = 0$, so $A \ge 0$. If $A = 0$, then $\operatorname{Re} g$ vanishes on the circle, hence on the disc, and $g$ is an imaginary constant equal to $g(0) = 0$. Let $A > 0$. By the maximum principle $\operatorname{Re} g \le A$ on $|z| \le R$, so $|2A - g| \ge A$ there and $\phi = g/(2A-g)$ is holomorphic. Since $|g|^2 - |2A-g|^2 = 4A(\operatorname{Re} g - A) \le 0$, we have $|\phi| \le 1$, and $\phi(0) = 0$. Schwarz's lemma gives $|\phi(z)| \le |z|/R$, and from $g = 2A\phi/(1+\phi)$ we get $|g(z)| \le 2A|z|/(R-|z|)$. □

**Lemma 3.5.** *Let $0 < \delta < 1/1000$, $1/2 \le a \le 1$, and let $\chi$ be nonprincipal modulo $q$ with $L(s,\chi) \ne 0$ for $\operatorname{Re} s > a + 2\delta$. Put $K_1 = (1+2A_0)/(2\delta^2)$. For $a + 8\delta \le \sigma \le 2$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$,*

$$\left|\frac{L'}{L}(\sigma+it,\chi)\right| \le K_1 \log\big(2q(3+|t|)^2\big).$$

*Proof.* Let $c = 2+it$, $R = 2-a-3\delta$, $r = 2-a-6\delta$ and $\Lambda_0 = \log(2q(3+|t|)^2) \ge \log 18 > 1$. On the disc $|z-c| < 2-a-2\delta$ we have $\operatorname{Re} z > a+2\delta$, so $L(z,\chi)$ has no zero there and has a holomorphic logarithm $h$. On $|z-c| < 1/2$ both $h$ and the function $E$ of Lemma 3.3 are logarithms of $L$, so they differ by a constant in $2\pi i\mathbb{Z}$; we choose $h = E$ there. Then $|h(c)| \le A_0$.

If $|z-c| \le R$, then $\operatorname{Re} z \ge a + 3\delta \ge 1/2$ and $|z| \le |c| + 3/2 \le 4 + |t|$, so Lemma 3.2 gives $\operatorname{Re} h(z) = \log|L(z,\chi)| \le \log(2q(4+|t|)) \le \Lambda_0$. Lemma 3.4 gives, for $|z-c| \le r$,

$$|h(z)-h(c)| \le \frac{2r}{R-r}\big(\Lambda_0 + A_0\big) \le \frac{\Lambda_0 + A_0}{\delta},$$

as $r \le 3/2$ and $R - r = 3\delta$. Hence $|h(z)| \le A_0 + (\Lambda_0 + A_0)/\delta \le (1+2A_0)\Lambda_0/\delta$ on $|z-c| \le r$. For $w = \sigma + it$ with $a + 8\delta \le \sigma \le 2$ we have $|w-c| = 2-\sigma \le r - 2\delta$, so the circle $|z-w| = 2\delta$ lies in $|z-c| \le r$, and Cauchy's estimate gives $|L'/L(w,\chi)| = |h'(w)| \le (1+2A_0)\Lambda_0/(2\delta^2)$. □

**Lemma 3.6.** *For $q \geq 1$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$ and $s = \sigma + it$ with $\sigma \geq 1/2$,*

$$\log\bigl(2q(3+|t|)^2\bigr) \leq 10\log(q+2)(1+|t|)^{1/2}, \qquad |s(s+1)| \geq \tfrac{1}{8}(1+|t|)^2.$$

*Proof.* We have $\log(2q) \leq 2\log(q+2)$, and $\log y \leq 2y^{1/2}$ with $3+|t| \leq 4(1+|t|)$ gives $\log(3+|t|) \leq 4(1+|t|)^{1/2}$; the first bound follows from $\log(q+2) \geq 1$. For the second, $|s| \geq \max(\sigma, |t|) \geq (1+|t|)/4$ and $|s+1| \geq \max(\sigma+1, |t|) \geq (1+|t|)/2$. □

**Proposition 3.7.** *Let $0 < \delta < 1/1000$. There is $K = K(\delta)$ such that the following holds. Let $1/2 \leq a \leq 1$ and let $\chi$ be nonprincipal modulo $q$ with $L(s,\chi) \neq 0$ for $\operatorname{Re} s > a + 2\delta$. Then for $x \geq 1$,*

$$|S(\chi; x)| \leq K\, x^{a+8\delta} \log(q+2).$$

*Proof.* Put $\sigma_0 = a + 8\delta$ and

$$\Phi(s) = -\frac{L'}{L}(s,\chi)\,\frac{x^s}{s(s+1)}.$$

For $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$, $-L'/L(s,\chi) = \sum_n \chi(n)\Lambda(n)n^{-s}$, so Lemma 3.1(ii) gives $S(\chi;x) = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int \Phi(2+it)\,dt$. The function $\Phi$ is holomorphic on $\sigma_0 \leq \operatorname{Re} s \leq 2$, and by Lemmas 3.5 and 3.6,

$$|\Phi(\sigma+it)| \leq 80K_1 \log(q+2)\, x^{\sigma}(1+|t|)^{-3/2} \qquad (\sigma_0 \leq \sigma \leq 2).$$

This tends to 0 as $|t| \to \infty$ uniformly in $\sigma$, so Cauchy's theorem on the rectangles $[\sigma_0, 2] \times [-T, T]$, $T \to \infty$, moves the integral to $\operatorname{Re} s = \sigma_0$ (Figure 2). Since $\int_{\mathbb{R}}(1+|t|)^{-3/2}dt = 4$, we get $|S(\chi;x)| \leq \frac{160K_1}{\pi} x^{\sigma_0}\log(q+2)$. □

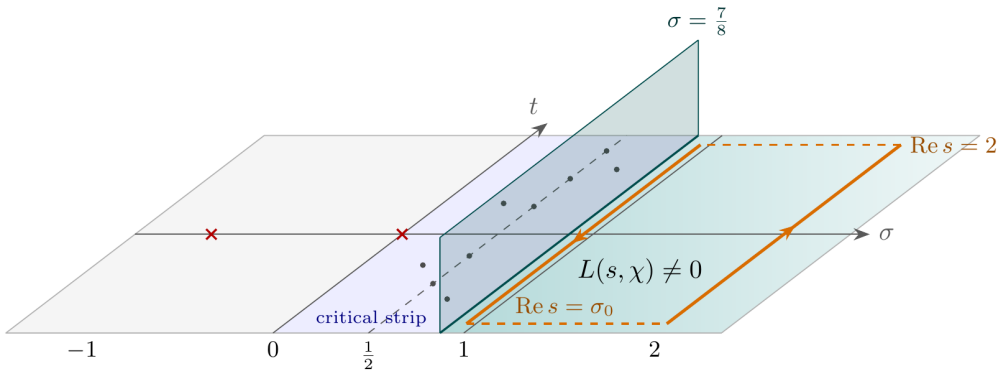



FIGURE 2. The contour shift in the proof of Proposition 3.7. The zeros of $L(s,\chi)$ lie in the strip $0 \leq \operatorname{Re} s \leq 7/8$ (dots), the kernel $x^s/(s(s+1))$ has poles at 0 and $-1$ (crosses), and the line of integration moves from $\operatorname{Re} s = 2$ to $\operatorname{Re} s = \sigma_0$ inside the zero-free half-plane.

From now on fix $\delta = 1/2000$ and $a = 7/8 - 1/1000$, so that $a + 2\delta = 7/8$ and

$$\sigma_0 = a + 8\delta = \frac{7}{8} + \frac{3}{1000},$$

and let $K$ be the constant of Proposition 3.7 for this $\delta$. By Theorem 1.2, Proposition 3.7 applies to every nonprincipal character.

**Corollary 3.8.** *There is an absolute constant $C_3$ such that for every nonprincipal character $\xi$ modulo $k$:*

(i) $|S(\xi;x)| \le Kx^{\sigma_0}\log(k+2)$ *for* $x \ge 1$;
(ii) $\bigl|\sum_{p\le x}\xi(p)\log p\bigr| \le C_3 x^{19/20}\log(k+2)$ *for* $x \ge 1$;
(iii) *for integers* $2 \le A \le B$ *and* $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$\Bigl|\sum_{A<p\le B}\xi(p)e(p\gamma)\Bigr| \le 2C_3\,\frac{B^{19/20}\log(k+2)(2+2\pi|\gamma|B)}{\log A}. \tag{3.1}$$

*Proof.* (i) is Proposition 3.7. For (ii) put $T(y) = yS(\xi;y)$, that is, $T(y) = \sum_{n\le y}\xi(n)\Lambda(n)(y-n)$, and let $0 < h \le x$. Then

$$T(x+h) - T(x) = h\sum_{n\le x}\xi(n)\Lambda(n) + \sum_{x<n\le x+h}\xi(n)\Lambda(n)(x+h-n),$$

and the last sum has at most $h+1$ terms, each of modulus at most $h\log(2x)$. With $|T(y)| \le Ky^{1+\sigma_0}\log(k+2)$ this gives

$$\Bigl|\sum_{n\le x}\xi(n)\Lambda(n)\Bigr| \le \frac{2K(2x)^{1+\sigma_0}\log(k+2)}{h} + (h+1)\log(2x).$$

Take $h = x^{47/50}$. Since $1 + \sigma_0 - 47/50 < 19/20$ and $\log(2x) \le 1 + 100x^{1/100}$, the right side is at most $(8K+202)x^{19/20}\log(k+2)$. The prime powers contribute at most $\psi(x) - \theta(x) \le 2\sqrt{x}\log x \le 200x^{19/20}$ by Lemma 2.1(ii), and (ii) follows with $C_3 = 8K + 402$.

(iii) Let $\Pi(u) = \sum_{p\le u}\xi(p)\log p$ and $f(u) = e(u\gamma)/\log u$. Partial summation gives

$$\sum_{A<p\le B}\xi(p)e(p\gamma) = f(B)\Pi(B) - f(A)\Pi(A) - \int_A^B \Pi(u)f'(u)\,du,$$

and $|f'(u)| \le 2\pi|\gamma|/\log A + 1/(u\log^2 u)$ for $u \ge A$. By (ii) the right side is at most $C_3B^{19/20}\log(k+2)\bigl(3 + 2\pi|\gamma|B\bigr)/\log A$, which gives (3.1). □

## 4. Exponential sums with multiplicative coefficients

For $M > 0$ put $w_M(\theta) = M$ if $\|\theta\| < 1/M$ and $w_M(\theta) = 1/\|\theta\|$ otherwise; then $0 \le w_M(\theta) \le M$ and $w_M(-\theta) = w_M(\theta)$.

**Theorem 4.1.** *There is an absolute constant $C_1$ with the following property. Let $f$ be completely multiplicative with $|f(n)| \le 1$, let $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, and let $a, r$ be coprime integers with $r \ge 1$, $|\alpha - a/r| \le r^{-2}$ and $2 \le R \le r \le N/R$. Then*

$$\Big|\sum_{n\le N} f(n)e(n\alpha)\Big| \le C_1\Big(\frac{N}{\log N} + \frac{N(\log N)^2}{R^{1/4}}\Big).$$

Montgomery and Vaughan [12, Corollary 1] proved this for multiplicative $f$ with $N(\log R)^{3/2}R^{-1/2}$ in place of $N(\log N)^2R^{-1/4}$. The proof below follows their approach, a bilinear decomposition together with the spacing of the multiples of $\alpha$ and an upper bound for prime pairs, with cruder estimates, which suffice for Theorem 1.1.

**Lemma 4.2.** *Let $a, r$ be coprime with $r \ge 2$ and $|\alpha - a/r| \le r^{-2}$, and let $H \ge 0$ be an integer.*

(i) *$\|k\alpha\| \ge 1/(2r)$ for every integer $k$ with $0 < |k| \le r/2$.*

(ii) *$\#\{1 \le h \le H : \|h\alpha\| < t\} \le (4H/r + 1)(4rt + 1)$ for every $t \ge 0$.*

(iii) *For $M > 0$ and every integer $K \ge 0$ with $M \le 2^K$,*

$$\sum_{h\le H} w_M(h\alpha) \le \Big(\frac{4H}{r} + 1\Big)(3M + 4r + 8rK),$$

$$\sum_{h\le H} w_M(h\alpha)^2 \le \Big(\frac{4H}{r} + 1\Big)(20rM + 3M^2).$$

*Proof.* (i) Let $z$ be the integer nearest to $k\alpha$. Since $0 < |k| < r$ and $(a, r) = 1$, $r \nmid ka$, so $|ka/r - z| \ge 1/r$ and $\|k\alpha\| \ge 1/r - |k|\,|\alpha - a/r| \ge 1/(2r)$.

(ii) Let $L = \lfloor r/2 \rfloor$, so $L \ge r/4$. For $k$ in a block of $L$ consecutive integers let $y_k = k\alpha - z_k$ with $z_k$ the integer nearest to $k\alpha$. For $k \ne k'$ in the block, $0 < |k-k'| < L \le r/2$ and $y_k - y_{k'} \equiv (k-k')\alpha \pmod 1$, so $|y_k - y_{k'}| \ge 1/(2r)$ by (i). Points of $(-t, t)$ at mutual distances at least $1/(2r)$ number at most $4rt + 1$, and $[1, H]$ is covered by at most $H/L + 1 \le 4H/r + 1$ blocks.

(iii) If $\|\theta\| \ge 1/M$, let $k \ge 1$ be least with $\|\theta\| < 2^k/M$; then $k \le K$ because $\|\theta\| \le 1/2 < 2^K/M$, and $\|\theta\| \ge 2^{k-1}/M$, so $w_M(\theta) \le 2^{1-k}M$. Hence

$$w_M(\theta)^j \le M^j\,[\|\theta\| < 1/M] + \sum_{k=1}^{K}(2^{1-k}M)^j\,[\|\theta\| < 2^k/M] \qquad (j = 1, 2).$$

Summing over $h \le H$ with (ii), the first sum is at most $(4H/r + 1)\big(4r + M + \sum_{k\le K}(8r + 2^{1-k}M)\big)$ and the second at most $(4H/r + 1)\big(4rM + M^2 + \sum_{k\ge1}(16rM2^{-k} + 4M^24^{-k})\big)$. □

**Lemma 4.3.** *Let $\theta, \alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, $U > 0$, and let $A, B, N$ be nonnegative integers with $B \le A + U$.*

(i) $\bigl|\sum_{A<x\le B} e(x\theta)\bigr| \le w_U(\theta)$.

(ii) *For a finite set $V$ of positive integers and $b : V \to \mathbb{C}$,*

$$\sum_{A<u\le B}\Bigl|\sum_{\substack{v\in V\\ uv\le N}} b(v)e(uv\alpha)\Bigr|^2 \le \sum_{v,v'\in V} |b(v)|\,|b(v')|\,w_U\bigl((v-v')\alpha\bigr).$$

(iii) *For $M > 0$ and an integer $H \ge 0$, $\sum_{1\le m,m'\le H} w_M((m-m')\alpha) \le H\bigl(M + 2\sum_{h\le H} w_M(h\alpha)\bigr)$.*

*Proof.* (i) If $\|\theta\| < 1/U$, the sum has at most $U$ terms of modulus 1. Otherwise $\theta \notin \mathbb{Z}$, the sum has modulus at most $|e((B-A)\theta)-1|/|e(\theta)-1|$, and $|e(\theta)-1| = 2|\sin\pi\theta| \ge 4\|\theta\|$, so the modulus is at most $1/(2\|\theta\|)$. (ii) Expanding the square gives $\sum_{v,v'} b(v)\overline{b(v')}\sum_u e(u(v-v')\alpha)$, where $u$ runs over the integers of $(A, \min(B, N/v, N/v')]$, an interval of length at most $U$; apply (i). (iii) For fixed $m$, the term $m' = m$ is $w_M(0) = M$, and each $h = |m-m'| \in [1, H]$ arises from at most two $m'$. □

**Lemma 4.4.** *Let $C_5 = 1 + 4\zeta(3/2)$. For every completely multiplicative $f$ with $|f(n)| \le 1$, every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ and every integer $N \ge 1$, the sum $S = \sum_{n\le N} f(n)e(n\alpha)$ satisfies*

$$\Bigl|S\log N - \sum_{p\le N}\log p\, f(p)\sum_{m\le N/p} f(m)e(pm\alpha)\Bigr| \le C_5 N.$$

*Proof.* Write $S\log N = S_1 + S_2$ with $S_1 = \sum_{n\le N} f(n)e(n\alpha)\log n$ and $S_2 = \sum_{n\le N} f(n)e(n\alpha)\log(N/n)$. Then $|S_2| \le N\log N - \log N! \le N$, since $N^N/N! \le e^N$. In $S_1$ write $\log n = \sum_{d\mid n}\Lambda(d)$ and $n = dm$; complete multiplicativity gives $\sum_{d\le N}\Lambda(d)f(d)\sum_{m\le N/d} f(m)e(dm\alpha)$. The terms with $d$ prime form the sum in the statement, and the others have modulus at most $N\sum_p\sum_{k\ge 2}\log p/p^k \le 2N\sum_p \log p/p^2 \le 4\zeta(3/2)N$, since $\log p \le 2\sqrt{p}$. □

Let $G(h) = \prod_{p\mid h} p/(p-1)$.

**Lemma 4.5.** (i) *For every integer $X \ge 2$ and every even $h \ge 2$,*

$$\#\{0 \le n < X : n \text{ and } n+h \text{ prime}\} \le \frac{400\,G(h)^2 X}{(\log X)^2} + 3X^{3/5}.$$

(ii) $\sum_{h\le X} G(h)^4 \le e^{30}X$ *for every $X \ge 1$.*

*Proof.* (i) Apply Lemma 2.2 to $a_n = n(n+h)$, $0 \le n < X$, with $y = X^{1/5}$, $z = \lfloor y\rfloor$, $P$ the product of the primes $p \le z$ with $p \nmid h$, and $\nu(d) = 2^{\omega(d)}/d$. Every $p \mid P$ is odd, so $\nu(p) = 2/p < 1$. For $d \mid P$ the residues $n$ with $d \mid n(n+h)$ form $2^{\omega(d)}$ classes modulo $d$ (namely $n \equiv 0$ or $-h \pmod p$ for each $p \mid d$, distinct as $p \nmid h$), and each class contains between $X/d - 1$ and $X/d + 1$ of the integers $0 \le n < X$; hence $|R_d| \le 2^{\omega(d)}$. Since the prime

factors of $d$ are at least 3, $3^{\omega(d)}|R_d| \le 6^{\omega(d)} \le d^2 \le y^2$, and the error term is at most $y^3 = X^{3/5}$.

Let $\mathcal{M}$ be the set of $m \le \sqrt{y}$ whose prime factors divide $P$. Since $\nu(p)/(1-\nu(p)) = \sum_{k\ge1} \nu(p)^k$ and $\nu(m) = 2^{\Omega(m)}/m$ for these $m$, $g(l)$ is the sum of $2^{\Omega(m)}/m$ over the $m$ whose set of prime factors is that of $l$. An $m \in \mathcal{M}$ is counted in $g(l)$ for $l$ the product of its prime factors, and $l \le m \le \sqrt{y}$. Hence, with $\tau(m) \le 2^{\Omega(m)}$ the number of divisors of $m$,

$$S \ge \sum_{m\in\mathcal{M}} \frac{2^{\Omega(m)}}{m} \ge \sum_{m\in\mathcal{M}} \frac{\tau(m)}{m}.$$

Let $T = \lfloor y^{1/4} \rfloor$ and let $B$ be the set of $b \le T$ that are prime to $h$; these $b$ are odd. For $b, b' \in B$ the product $bb'$ lies in $\mathcal{M}$, and a given $m$ is a product $bb'$ in at most $\tau(m)$ ways, so $S \ge \big(\sum_{b\in B} 1/b\big)^2$. If $E$ is a set of primes and $p \notin E$, every $b \le T$ prime to $E$ is uniquely $p^k b'$ with $b'$ prime to $E \cup \{p\}$, so the sum of $1/b$ over the $b \le T$ prime to $E$ is at most $p/(p-1)$ times the same sum for $E \cup \{p\}$. Adding the prime factors of $h$ one at a time gives

$$\sum_{b\in B} \frac{1}{b} \ge \frac{1}{G(h)} \sum_{b\le T} \frac{1}{b} \ge \frac{\log(T+1)}{G(h)}.$$

As $T + 1 > y^{1/4} = X^{1/20}$, we get $S \ge (\log X)^2/(400G(h)^2)$, that is, $X/S \le 400G(h)^2 X/(\log X)^2$. Finally, if $n < X$ and $n, n+h$ are prime, then $n \le z$ or $(n(n+h), P) = 1$, so the count is at most $z + 1 + X/S + y^3 \le 400G(h)^2 X/(\log X)^2 + 3X^{3/5}$.

(ii) For $t = p-1 \ge 1$, $(t+1)^5 \le (t+31)t^4$, that is, $(p/(p-1))^4 \le 1 + 30/p$. Hence $G(h)^4 \le \sum_d 30^{\omega(d)}/d$ over the squarefree $d \mid h$, and

$$\sum_{h\le X} G(h)^4 \le \sum_{d\le X} \mu(d)^2 \frac{30^{\omega(d)}}{d} \cdot \frac{X}{d} \le X \prod_p \Big(1 + \frac{30}{p^2}\Big)$$
$$\le X \exp\Big(30 \sum_{n\ge2} \frac{1}{n^2}\Big) \le e^{30} X. \qquad \square$$

*Proof of Theorem 4.1.* Let $S$ be the sum in the theorem, $L = \log N$ and $\ell = \lfloor \log_2 N \rfloor$. Since $N \ge rR \ge 4$, we have $L \ge 1$. If $\ell < 64$, then $L < 64 \log 2 < 45$ and $|S| \le N \le 45N/L$. Let now $\ell \ge 64$, and put $I = \lfloor \log_2 \ell \rfloor + 1$ and $J = \ell + 1 - 4I$. Then $16^I > \ell^4$, $1 \le J \le \ell \le 2L$, $I \le \ell \le 2L$, $2^I \le 2\ell$, $N < 2^{\ell+1} = 2^J 16^I$ and $J^2 2^J \le (\ell+1)^2 2^{\ell+1} \ell^{-4} \le 2N$. By Lemma 4.4, $|S|L \le C_5 N + |T_1| + |T_2|$, where $T_1$ and $T_2$ are the parts of $\sum_p \log p\, f(p) \sum_{m\le N/p} f(m) e(pm\alpha)$ with $p \le 2^J$ and with $p > 2^J$.

*The small primes.* Let $0 \le j < J$, $U = 2^j$, $H = \lfloor N/U \rfloor$, and for $U < x \le 2U$ let $B(x) = \sum_{m\le H,\, xm\le N} f(m) e(xm\alpha)$; the inner sum for a

prime $p \in (U, 2U]$ is $B(p)$. By Cauchy's inequality, Lemma 4.3(ii), (iii) and Lemma 4.2(iii) with $M = U$, $K = j$,

$$\sum_{U<p\le 2U} \log p\,|B(p)| \le \big(U\log^2(2U)\big)^{1/2} Q_j^{1/2},$$

where $Q_j = H\big(U + 2(4H/r+1)(3U+4r+8rj)\big)$. Since $HU \le N$, $UQ_j \le 7NU + (8+16j)Nr + 24N^2/r + (32+64j)N^2/U$, and $\log(2U) \le j+1$. Summing over $j < J$ with $j+1 \le J$, $\sum_{j<J} 2^{j/2} \le 3\cdot 2^{J/2}$, $\sqrt{(32+64j)2^{-j}} \le 8(j+1)(3/4)^j$ and $\sum_{j\ge 0}(j+1)^2(3/4)^j = 112$,

$$|T_1| \le 3\sqrt{7}J\sqrt{N2^J} + J^2N\sqrt{24/r} + 896N + J^2\sqrt{24JNr}.$$

Now $J^2 2^J \le 2N$ gives $3\sqrt{7}J\sqrt{N2^J} \le 12N$; $r \ge R \ge \sqrt{R}$ gives $\sqrt{24/r} \le 5R^{-1/4}$; and $r\sqrt{R} \le rR \le N$ gives $\sqrt{24JNr} \le 5JNR^{-1/4}$. With $J \le 2L$ and $L \ge 1$, $|T_1| \le 908N + 60L^3NR^{-1/4}$.

*The large primes.* For $p > 2^J$ we have $N/p < 16^I$, so the $m$ in $T_2$ lie in $(0, 16^I - 1]$, the union of the blocks $(16^i - 1, 16^{i+1} - 1]$ with $0 \le i < I$. Fix $i$, let $A = 16^i - 1$, $U = 15\cdot 16^i$ and $X = \lfloor N/16^i \rfloor$, and assume $X \ge 1$, the block being empty otherwise. Only the primes $p \in (2^J, X]$ contribute, since $p \ge X+1$ and $m \ge 16^i$ give $pm > N$. Let $V$ be the set of these primes, which are odd, and $B(m) = \sum_{p\in V,\, pm\le N} \log p\, f(p) e(pm\alpha)$. The block is $\sum_{A<m\le A+U} f(m)B(m)$, and by Cauchy's inequality, Lemma 4.3(ii) and $\log p \le \lambda = \log(X+1)$, its square is at most $U\lambda^2 W$, where

$$W = \sum_{p,p'\in V} w_U((p-p')\alpha) = |V|U + 2\sum_{h=1}^{X} w_U(h\alpha)\,\#\{p \in V : p+h \in V\}.$$

The count vanishes for odd $h$, and for even $h$ Lemma 4.5(i), applied to $X+1$, bounds it by $400G(h)^2(X+1)\lambda^{-2} + 3(X+1)^{3/5}$. By Cauchy's inequality, Lemma 4.5(ii) and Lemma 4.2(iii), $\sum_{h\le X} G(h)^2 w_U(h\alpha) \le e^{15}\sqrt{X}Q^{1/2}$ with $Q = (4X/r+1)(20rU+3U^2)$, and $\sum_{h\le X} w_U(h\alpha) \le XU$. Hence $U\lambda^2 W \le A_1 + 800e^{15}Z + A_3$, where

$$A_1 = U^2\lambda^2 X, \qquad Z = U(X+1)\sqrt{X}Q^{1/2}, \qquad A_3 = 6U^2\lambda^2(X+1)^{3/5}X.$$

Let $\kappa = \log(N+1) \ge \lambda$ and $T_i = 4^i\kappa\,(N(2N)^{3/5})^{1/2}$. Since $U^2X = 225\cdot 16^i(16^iX) \le 225\cdot 16^iN$ and $X+1 \le 2N$, we get $A_1 \le 225T_i^2$ and $A_3 \le 1350T_i^2 \le 37^2T_i^2$. With $w = UX \le 15N$, $X \le N/16^i$ and $R \le r \le N/R$,

$$\begin{aligned} Z^2 \le 4U^2X^3Q &= 320w^3X + \frac{48w^4}{r} + 80rw^3 + 12Uw^3 \\ &\le \frac{320\cdot 15^3N^4}{16^i} + \frac{48\cdot 15^4N^4}{R} + \frac{80\cdot 15^3N^4}{R} \\ &\quad + 180\cdot 15^3\cdot 16^iN^3, \end{aligned}$$

and every coefficient is at most $40^4$, so $Z^{1/2} \le 40(N2^{-i}+2NR^{-1/4}+2^iN^{3/4})$. The block is therefore at most

$$\begin{aligned} &15T_i + 40\sqrt{800e^{15}}\big(N2^{-i} + 2NR^{-1/4} + 2^iN^{3/4}\big) + 37T_i \\ &\qquad \le K_b\big(N2^{-i} + NR^{-1/4} + 2^iN^{3/4} + T_i\big), \end{aligned}$$

with $K_b = 80\sqrt{800e^{15}} + 52$. Summing over $i < I$,

$$|T_2| \le K_b\big(2N + INR^{-1/4} + 2^IN^{3/4} + 4^I\kappa(N(2N)^{3/5})^{1/2}\big).$$

Here $I \le 2L^3$; $2^I \le 4L \le 16N^{1/4}$; $4^I \le 16L^2$ and $\kappa \le 2L$; and $\log x \le 15x^{1/15}$ gives $L^3(N(2N)^{3/5})^{1/2} \le 2 \cdot 15^3N$. Hence $|T_2| \le K_b(216018N + 2L^3NR^{-1/4})$.

Altogether $|S|L \le (C_5 + 908 + 216018K_b)N + (60 + 2K_b)L^3NR^{-1/4}$, and dividing by $L$ gives the theorem with $C_1 = 45 + C_5 + 908 + 216018K_b + 60 + 2K_b$. □

## 5. Proof of Theorem 1.1

In this section $\chi$ is a primitive character modulo $q \ge 3$.

**Lemma 5.1.** *Let $B \ge 0$ be such that $\big|\sum_{m\le H} \bar\chi(m)e(m\beta)/m\big| \le B$ for every integer $H \le q/2$ and every $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$. Then $\big|\sum_{n\le x} \chi(n)\big| \le \sqrt{q}\,(B+6)$ for every $x \ge 0$.*

*Proof.* We may take $x = T$ to be an integer. Let $\tau = \sum_{a \bmod q} \bar\chi(a)e(a/q)$. Since $\bar\chi$ is primitive, $\sum_a \bar\chi(a)e(an/q) = \chi(n)\tau$ for every $n$, and summing the squares of the moduli of these identities over $n$ mod $q$ gives $q\varphi(q) = |\tau|^2\varphi(q)$, so $|\tau| = \sqrt{q}$. Summing over $1 \le n \le T$,

$$\tau \sum_{n\le T} \chi(n) = \sum_{0<|a|\le q/2} \bar\chi(a)\,\frac{e(aT/q) - 1}{1 - e(-a/q)},$$

where $a$ runs over the integers with $-q/2 < a \le q/2$, $a \ne 0$. For $0 < |\theta| \le 1/2$ put $r(\theta) = (1-e(-\theta))^{-1} - (2\pi i\theta)^{-1}$; then $|1-e(-\theta)| = 2|\sin\pi\theta| \ge 4|\theta|$. If $2\pi|\theta| \le 1$, then $|e(-\theta) - 1 + 2\pi i\theta| \le (2\pi\theta)^2$ and $|r(\theta)| \le (2\pi\theta)^2/(4|\theta| \cdot 2\pi|\theta|) < 3$; otherwise $|r(\theta)| \le 1/(4|\theta|) + 1/(2\pi|\theta|) < 3$. The terms with $r(a/q)$ contribute at most $6q$. Writing $a = \pm m$ with $1 \le m \le q/2$, the remaining terms are $q/(2\pi i)$ times a combination, with coefficients of modulus at most 1, of four sums $\sum_{m\le H} \bar\chi(m)e(m\beta)/m$ with $H \le q/2$, so they contribute at most $2qB/\pi$. Dividing by $|\tau|$ gives the claim. □

**Lemma 5.2.** *For $Y \ge 2$ and $H \ge 1$,*

$$\sum_{\substack{n\le H \\ P(n)\le Y}} \frac{1}{n} \le e^{11}\log Y.$$

*Proof.* The sum is at most $\prod_{p\le Y}(1-1/p)^{-1} \le \exp\bigl(\sum_{p\le Y}\frac{1}{p-1}\bigr)$, and $\sum_p\bigl(\frac{1}{p-1}-\frac{1}{p}\bigr)\le 1$; apply Lemma 2.1(iv). □

**Lemma 5.3.** *There is an absolute constant $C_2$ such that for $0<r<q$, $b\in\mathbb{Z}$, $\beta\in\mathbb{R}$, integers $Y\ge\max(2,r)$ and $t\ge 1$,*

$$\Bigl|\sum_{\substack{n\le t\\ P(n)>Y}}\chi(n)e\Bigl(n\Bigl(\frac{b}{r}+\beta\Bigr)\Bigr)\Bigr| \le C_2\,\frac{r\log(qr+2)\,(2+2\pi|\beta|t)\,t}{Y^{1/20}\log Y}.$$

*Proof.* Every $n\le t$ with $P(n)>Y$ is uniquely $n=pm$ with $p=P(n)$ prime, $Y<p\le t/m$ and $P(m)\le p$, and then $m\le t/Y$. For such $p$ we have $p>r$, so $p\nmid r$, and on the units modulo $r$ the function $u\mapsto e(umb/r)$ equals $\sum_\psi c_\psi\psi(u)$, the sum over the characters $\psi$ modulo $r$, with $|c_\psi|\le 1$.

The character $\chi\psi$ modulo $qr$ is nonprincipal. Otherwise $\chi(n)=\bar\psi(n)$ for every $n$ prime to $qr$. Let $d=(q,r)$ and let $n$ be prime to $q$ with $n\equiv 1 \pmod d$. By the Chinese remainder theorem there is $n'$ prime to $qr$ with $n'\equiv n \pmod q$ and $n'\equiv 1 \pmod r$, and then $\chi(n)=\chi(n')=\bar\psi(n')=1$. So $\chi$ is trivial on the units congruent to 1 modulo $d$, and is induced by a character modulo $d\le r<q$, which contradicts primitivity.

Applying (3.1) to $\xi=\chi\psi$ with $\gamma=m\beta$, $A=\max(Y,P(m)-1)$ and $B=\lfloor t/m\rfloor$ (the inner sum is empty if $A\ge B$) gives

$$\Bigl|\sum_{\substack{n\le t\\ P(n)>Y}}\chi(n)e\Bigl(n\Bigl(\frac{b}{r}+\beta\Bigr)\Bigr)\Bigr| \le 2C_3 r\,\frac{\log(qr+2)(2+2\pi|\beta|t)}{\log Y}\sum_{m\le t/Y}\Bigl(\frac{t}{m}\Bigr)^{19/20},$$

and $\sum_{m\le M} m^{-19/20}\le 20M^{1/20}$. Hence $C_2=40C_3$ will do. □

**Proposition 5.4.** *There is an absolute constant $C_4$ such that if $\log q\ge 200$, then $\bigl|\sum_{m\le H}\chi(m)e(m\beta)/m\bigr| \le C_4\log\log q$ for every integer $H\le q$ and every $\beta\in\mathbb{R}$.*

*Proof.* Let $L=\log q$, $M=\lceil L\rceil$, $R=M^{16}$ and $Y=M^{700}$. Since $e^{L/16}\ge (L/16)^4/24 > L+1\ge M$, we have $2\le R<q$ and $R\le Y$. Split the sum according to $P(m)\le Y$ or $P(m)>Y$. By Lemma 5.2 the first part is at most $e^{11}\log Y$. For the second put $A(t)=\sum_{n\le t,\,P(n)>Y}\chi(n)e(n\beta)$ and $w(t)=1/t-1/(t+1)$. Partial summation and $|A(H)|\le H$ give

$$\Bigl|\sum_{\substack{m\le H\\ P(m)>Y}}\frac{\chi(m)e(m\beta)}{m}\Bigr| \le 1+\sum_{1\le t<H}|A(t)|\,w(t).$$

If $t\le Y$, then $A(t)=0$. Let $t>Y$ and $Q=\lfloor t/R\rfloor\ge 1$. By Dirichlet's theorem there are coprime $a,r$ with $1\le r\le Q$ and $|\beta-a/r|\le 1/(r(Q+1))$;

then $|\beta - a/r|\, t \le R$ (Figure 3). If $r \le R$, then Lemma 5.3 with $b = a$ gives $|A(t)| \le C_2 k t$, where

$$k = \frac{R \log(qR+2)(2+2\pi R)}{Y^{1/20} \log Y}.$$

If $r > R$, then $R \le r \le t/R$ and $|\beta - a/r| \le r^{-2}$, so Theorem 4.1 for $f = \chi$ bounds the full sum $\sum_{n \le t} \chi(n) e(n\beta)$, and since $\log t \le L$, removing the $\Psi(t) = \#\{n \le t : P(n) \le Y\}$ smooth terms gives

$$|A(t)| \le C_1 \Big( \frac{t}{\log t} + t\rho \Big) + \Psi(t), \qquad \rho = \frac{L^2}{R^{1/4}} = \frac{L^2}{M^4}.$$

Since $tw(t) \le 1/t$ and $w(t) \le 1/t^2$,

$$\sum_{1 \le t < H} |A(t)|\, w(t) \le C_1 \sum_{2 \le t \le H} \frac{1}{t \log t} + (C_1 \rho + C_2 k) \sum_{t \le H} \frac{1}{t} + \sum_{1 \le t < H} \Psi(t) w(t).$$

The first sum is at most $3 + \log L$, the second at most $1 + L$, and by partial summation the third is at most $\sum_{n \le H,\, P(n) \le Y} 1/n \le e^{11} \log Y$. Finally $L \le M \le 2L$ gives $\rho(1+L) \le 2/M \le 1$; $\log(qR+2) \le 18M$, $2 + 2\pi R \le 8M^{16}$, $Y^{1/20} = M^{35}$ and $\log Y = 700 \log M \ge 700$ give $k(1+L) \le 288 M^{34}/(700 M^{35}) \le 1$; and $\log Y = 700 \log M \le 1400 \log L$. Collecting terms, the sum is at most $1 + 4C_1 + C_2 + (2800 e^{11} + C_1) \log L \le (2800 e^{11} + 1 + 5C_1 + C_2) \log L$. □

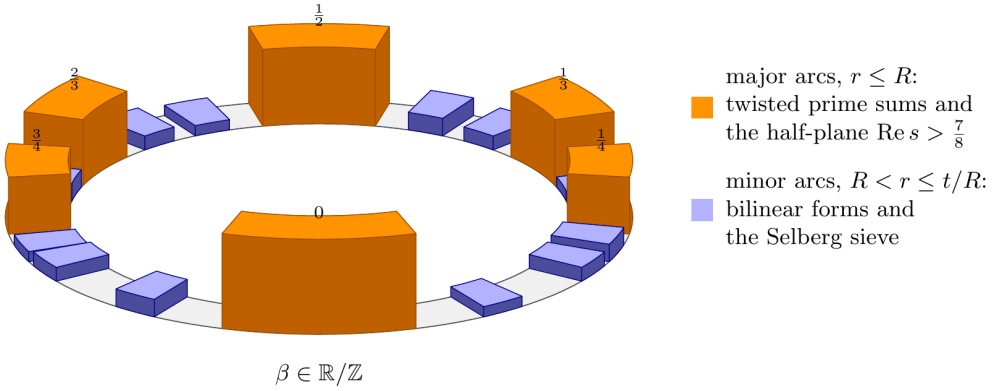



FIGURE 3. The dissection of $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ in the proof of Proposition 5.4, drawn for $R = 4$. Near a fraction $a/r$ with $r \le R$ (major arcs) the sum $A(t)$ is controlled by the twisted prime sums of Corollary 3.8; elsewhere (minor arcs) by Theorem 4.1. The heights only indicate that the major arcs carry the large values.

*Proof of Theorem 1.1.* The character $\bar\chi$ is primitive modulo $q$. If $\log q \ge 200$, then Proposition 5.4 for $\bar\chi$ and Lemma 5.1 give

$$\Big|\sum_{n\le x}\chi(n)\Big| \le \sqrt{q}\,(C_4\log\log q + 6) \le (C_4+6)\sqrt{q}\log\log q.$$

If $\log q < 200$, then every sum $\sum_{m\le H}\bar\chi(m)e(m\beta)/m$ with $H \le q$ has modulus at most $1+\log q < 201$, and Lemma 5.1 gives

$$\Big|\sum_{n\le x}\chi(n)\Big| \le 207\sqrt{q} \le \frac{207}{\log\log 3}\sqrt{q}\log\log q. \qquad \square$$

## 6. The logarithmic derivative at $s = 1$

Recall that $\sigma_0 = 7/8+3/1000$ and that $K$ is the constant of Corollary 3.8.

**Lemma 6.1.** *For every nonprincipal character $\chi$ modulo $q$,*

$$-\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi) = 2\int_1^\infty \frac{S(\chi;t)}{t^2}\,dt,$$

*and the integral converges absolutely.*

*Proof.* By Lemma 3.1(i) with $a = \chi\Lambda$, for real $s > 1$,

$$\int_1^\infty S(\chi;t)\,t^{-s-1}\,dt = -\frac{L'}{L}(s,\chi)\,\frac{1}{s(s+1)}.$$

As $s \to 1^+$ the left side tends to $\int_1^\infty S(\chi;t)t^{-2}dt$ by dominated convergence, since $|S(\chi;t)| \le Kt^{\sigma_0}\log(q+2)$ and $\sigma_0 < 1$. The function $L(s,\chi)$ is entire and does not vanish at $s = 1$ by Theorem 1.2, so the right side tends to $-\frac12\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi)$. $\square$

*Proof of Theorem 1.3(i).* Let $\chi$ be nonprincipal modulo $q$, so $q \ge 3$, and put $Y = \big(\log(q+2)\big)^{1/(1-\sigma_0)} \ge 1$. Since $|S(\chi;t)| \le \psi(t) \le 4t$ by Lemma 2.1(ii), Lemma 6.1 gives

$$\Big|\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi)\Big| \le 2\int_1^Y \frac{4\,dt}{t} + 2K\log(q+2)\int_Y^\infty t^{\sigma_0-2}\,dt = \frac{8\log\log(q+2)+2K}{1-\sigma_0}.$$

As $q+2 \le q^2$, $\log\log(q+2) \le \log 2+\log\log q$, and since $\log\log q \ge \log\log 3 > 0$ the right side is at most $C\log\log q$. $\square$

For the lower bound in Theorem 1.3(ii) we need to control the prime powers $n \le q^{17}$ with $n \equiv 1 \pmod q$. We count them in dyadic blocks with Selberg's sieve.

**Lemma 6.2.** *Let $q$ be prime, let $M \ge 1$ be an integer and let $1 < z < q$. The number of $m$ with $M \le m < 2M$ for which $1+mq$ is a prime power is at most*

$$\frac{2M}{\log z} + z(1+\log z)^2 + z.$$

*Proof.* If $1+mq = p^k$ with $p \le z$, then $p^k \in (Mq, 2Mq)$, and for each prime $p$ at most one power of $p$ lies in this interval, since $p^{k+1} \ge 2p^k$. These $m$ number at most $z$. If $p > z$, then $1+mq$ has no prime factor up to $z$, and we apply Lemma 2.2 to the $M$ integers $a_m = 1+mq$, $M \le m < 2M$, with $P$ the product of the primes up to $z$, $\nu(d) = 1/d$ and $y = z$. Every prime $p \le z$ differs from $q$, so for $d \mid P$ the condition $d \mid 1+mq$ fixes $m$ in one residue class modulo $d$, and $|R_d| \le 1$. Here $g(l) = \prod_{p\mid l}(p-1)^{-1}$, which is the sum of $1/n$ over the $n$ whose set of prime factors is that of $l$. Every $n \le \sqrt{z}$ has all its prime factors at most $z$ and the product of its distinct prime factors is at most $\sqrt{z}$, so

$$S = \sum_{\substack{l\mid P\\ l\le\sqrt{z}}} g(l) \ge \sum_{n\le\sqrt{z}} \frac{1}{n} \ge \frac{\log z}{2}.$$

For squarefree $d$, $3^{\omega(d)} = \tau_3(d)$, and $\sum_{d\le z}\tau_3(d) = \#\{(a,b,c) : abc \le z\} \le z\big(\sum_{a\le z} 1/a\big)^2 \le z(1+\log z)^2$. Lemma 2.2 therefore bounds the number of these $m$ by $2M/\log z + z(1+\log z)^2$. □

**Lemma 6.3.** *There is an absolute constant $C_0$ such that for every prime $q \ge 3$,*

$$\sum_{\substack{1<n\le q^{17}\\ n\equiv 1 \pmod q}} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n} \le C_0 \frac{\log q \log\log q}{q}.$$

*Proof.* Write $n = 1+mq$ with $1 \le m < q^{16}$, and let $J = \lfloor 16\log_2 q\rfloor + 1$, so that $2^J > q^{16}$ and $J \le 25\log q$. We split the range of $m$ into the blocks $2^j \le m < 2^{j+1}$, $0 \le j < J$ (Figure 4), and let $N_j$ be the number of $m$ in the $j$-th block with $1+mq$ a prime power. We claim $N_j \le 393\cdot 2^j/(j+1)$. For $j < 32$ this holds trivially. For $j \ge 32$ apply Lemma 6.2 with $M = 2^j$ and $z = 2^u$, $u = j/32 \ge 1$. Since $2^j < 2^J \le 2q^{16}$, we have $z < 2^{1/32}q^{1/2} < q$. Then $2M/\log z = 64\cdot 2^j/(j\log 2) \le 96\cdot 2^j/(j+1)$, and since $\log z \le u$,

$$z(1+\log z)^2 + z \le 2^u(2+u)^2 \le \frac{297\cdot 2^{4u}}{32u+1} \le \frac{297\cdot 2^j}{j+1},$$

because $(2+u)^2(32u+1) \le 9u^2\cdot 33u = 297u^3$ and $u^3 \le 2^{3u}$. This proves the claim.

A term of the $j$-th block has $\Lambda(n) \le \log(1+2^{j+1}q) \le (j+2)\log 2 + \log q$ and $n > 2^j q$, so the block contributes at most

$$\frac{393}{(j+1)q}\big((j+2)\log 2 + \log q\big) \le \frac{393}{q}\Big(2\log 2 + \frac{\log q}{j+1}\Big).$$

Summing over $j < J$ and using $\sum_{j<J} 1/(j+1) \le 1+\log J$, $J \le 25\log q$ and $\log J \le 4 + \log\log q$, the sum in the lemma is at most $\frac{393}{q}\big(35\log q +$

$5\log q + \log q \log\log q\big)$. Since $\log\log q \ge \log\log 3 > 1/11$, this is at most $C_0 \log q \log\log q/q$ with $C_0 = 393 \cdot 441$. □

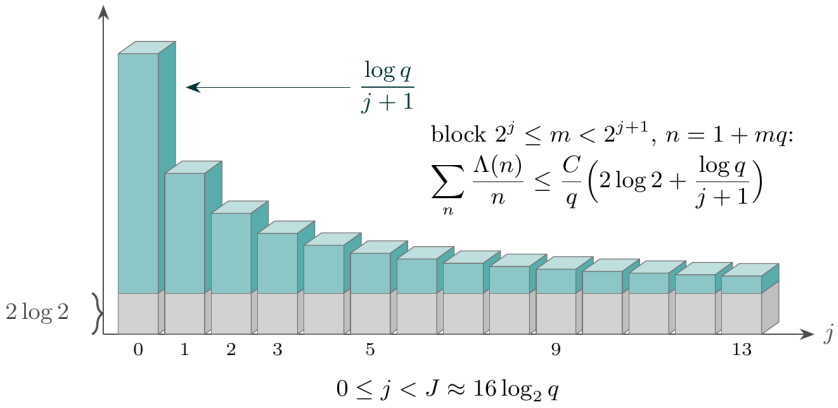



FIGURE 4. The dyadic blocks in the proof of Lemma 6.3. The block $2^j \le m < 2^{j+1}$ contributes a constant part, of total size $\ll J \ll \log q$, and a part of size $\log q/(j+1)$, whose total is $\ll \log q \log J$. The second part produces the factor $\log\log q$.

*Proof of Theorem 1.3(ii).* Let $q \ge 3$ be prime and put $c(n) = \sum_{\chi\ne\chi_0} \chi(n)$, the sum over the nonprincipal characters modulo $q$. By orthogonality $c(n) = (q-1)\mathbf{1}[n \equiv 1 \pmod q] - \mathbf{1}[q \nmid n]$. Put

$$T(t) = \sum_{\chi\ne\chi_0} S(\chi;t) = \sum_{n\le t} c(n)\Lambda(n)\Big(1 - \frac{n}{t}\Big), \qquad I = \int_1^\infty \frac{T(t)}{t^2}\,dt.$$

By Lemma 6.1, $\sum_{\chi\ne\chi_0} \frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi) = -2I$, so by (1.1) it suffices to show $-C\log q \le I \le C\log q \log\log q$.

By Corollary 3.8(i), $|T(t)| \le qK\log(q+2)\, t^{\sigma_0}$. Let $Y = q^{17}$. Since $17(\sigma_0 - 1) < -2$ and $\log(q+2) \le q$,

$$\Big|\int_Y^\infty \frac{T(t)}{t^2}\,dt\Big| \le \frac{qK\log(q+2)\,Y^{\sigma_0-1}}{1-\sigma_0} \le \frac{K\log(q+2)}{q(1-\sigma_0)} \le \frac{K}{1-\sigma_0}.$$

For the lower bound, $c(n) \ge -1$ gives $-T(t) \le \psi(t) \le 4t$, so

$$-I \le \int_1^Y \frac{4\,dt}{t} + \frac{K}{1-\sigma_0} = 68\log q + \frac{K}{1-\sigma_0}.$$

For the upper bound, $c(n) \le (q-1)\mathbf{1}[n \equiv 1 \pmod q]$ gives

$$\int_1^Y \frac{T(t)}{t^2}\,dt \le (q-1) \sum_{\substack{n \le Y \\ n \equiv 1 \pmod q}} \Lambda(n) \int_n^\infty \Big(1 - \frac{n}{t}\Big)\frac{dt}{t^2}$$
$$= \frac{q-1}{2} \sum_{\substack{1 < n \le q^{17} \\ n \equiv 1 \pmod q}} \frac{\Lambda(n)}{n},$$

which is at most $\frac{C_0}{2}\log q \log\log q$ by Lemma 6.3. Hence

$$I \le \frac{C_0}{2}\log q \log\log q + \frac{K}{1-\sigma_0},$$

and both bounds follow since $\log q > 1$ and $\log\log q > 1/11$. □

**Data and code availability.** The LaTeX source of the paper, the Lean 4 formalisation of its proofs together with the compiled sources of the zero-free half-plane [14], and the Python, Julia, C, C++ and shell programs that check its numerical steps are archived at Zenodo under `doi:10.5281/zenodo.23383715` [3]; the compiled paper is the only file of the folder `preprintPolyaVinogradovLogLog` of that archive and is available at `https://github.com/creelie/Breakthrough-problems-3/blob/main/preprintPolyaVinogradovLogLog/PolyaVinogradovLogLog.pdf`. Deep Bhattacharjee carried out the computations and the Lean, Julia, C, C++, Python and shell verifications, and the proofs and the text were drafted, with the help of AI assistance (Claude, Anthropic); the authors take full responsibility for every statement. Both authors approved the final version.

**Ethical declarations.** Funding: none. Competing interests: none.

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